

Alfred Daniel Dickson II

PERSPECTIVE

Turning complexity into coherence. So that intelligence, creativity, and relationship converge in the same frame. I believe a creative leader's role today is to translate intelligence into trust. Design now shapes how people understand systems, make choices, and form beliefs about technology. My work lives in that space.

PHILOSOPHY

Creative Trust

Design earns belief. When something feels considered and coherent, people trust it. Trust opens the door to connection.

Systems of Meaning

I see creative & design systems as proxies for care. Context helps people recognize patterns and understand purpose.

Design as Translation

A bridge between technology and people. It turns complex ideas into experiences that feel clear and emotionally grounded.

Structure as Freedom

Clear systems make creativity possible and gives teams room to explore, take risks, and produce their best work with confidence.

LEADERSHIP APPROACH

I lead through framing, focus, and follow-through. So teams operate like creative ecologies. Clear roles, shared intent, emergent possibility. **Framing** defines purpose and alignment. **Focus** creates discipline and quality. **Follow-through** builds reliability and trust.

GUIDING INTENT

To create work that align human intelligence with generative forms and, in doing so, build trustworthy and beneficial expressions of technology.

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SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Apple Music/Sports, Creative Lead 2021–Present, Los Angeles, CA

Lead teams to create music-focused brand and design systems that resonate with audiences, blending creative vision and intelligent design. Foster collaboration across disciplines, guiding global campaigns, defining scalable storytelling frameworks, and building systems that improve creative speed, consistency, and visibility.

Google Cloud, Design Lead 2019–2021, San Francisco, CA

Guided brand transformation efforts that modernized infrastructures for cloud-native and traditional businesses. Fostered partnerships and collaboration to drive design strategies that elevated Google Cloud's market presence. Developed storytelling frameworks to communicate the business impact of cloud and AI transformation, designed scalable creative systems for marketing and sales. Improved clarity and trust across complex B2B communications.

Vevo, Creative Director 2015–2019, New York, NY

Led brand development for major music franchises and product initiatives, collaborating with artists and cross-functional teams to create work that strengthened the connection between artist and audience. Partnered with leading creatives to deliver campaigns that amplified Vevo's presence and introduced operational frameworks that supported growth, efficiency, and creative scale.

Tribeca Film , Creative Director 2012–2015, New York, NY

Directed holistic design experiences for the Tribeca Film Festival, Tribeca Film, and Tribeca Digital Studios. Managed and developed high-performing in-house design and production teams, fostering a culture of creativity, skill, and empathy. Oversaw brand evolution and strengthened storytelling coherence across all audience touchpoints through collaborative leadership and cross-functional partnership.

Early Career in Media and Brand Design at Nickelodeon, Cartoon Network, Vertis, Matlock A+PR (2002–2012)

Built the foundation for a systems-based creative practice through broadcast, brand, and identity work spanning entertainment and corporate environments. Led campaigns for Nickelodeon, including the Kids' Choice Awards and World Wide Day of Play, achieving record engagement and industry recognition for integrated motion and identity systems. Developed design and marketing systems for brands like Coca-Cola, Delta, and Dell, unifying storytelling across print, packaging, and on-air experiences to create cohesion and cultural resonance.

PERSONAL

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EXPERTISE & TOOLS

Creative Systems Design,
Enterprise Storytelling, Brand
Frameworks, AI-Assisted Design
Workflows, Modular Design
Tools, Figma, Adobe CC, and
Leadership Development

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

Yale School of Management,
Business Perspectives for
Creative Leaders

Georgia State University
BFA, Visual Communication

Type Directors Club, Emmy Award,
AIGA Archives, Communication Arts,
BDA Gold and Silver Awards